The Binding of the Agent: Items and pickups

All items and pickups in the game.

Reading the numbers

Player base stats. Item effects are added to these first, then multipliers (×) are applied:

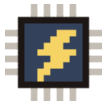
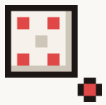
Stat	Base	Notes
Damage	3.5	per shot
Fire delay	0.38 s	time between shots, about 2.6 shots/s (shown as RATE in the HUD); lower is better
Speed	1.0	1.0 = 240 px/s
Shot speed	1.0	1.0 = 480 px/s
Range	420 px	
Shot size	1.0	1.0 = 9 px radius
Luck	0	more room-clear drops and better chances at rare pickups
Health	3 hearts	max 12 hearts in total, red and blue (guardrail) combined

Where items appear (the "Found in" column): **Treasure** room, **Shop** (for the listed price), **Boss** reward, **Secret** room. Each item appears at most once per run until every item has been seen.

Items

Stat items

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Cold Brew** `cold_brew`	Speed +0.25	Treasure, Shop, Boss	12¢	Caffeine: the original agentic framework.
	**Mechanical Keyboard** `mech_keyboard`	Fire delay −0.06 s	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Clack clack clack. Your open-plan office has filed a complaint.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Stack Overflow Printout** `stack_overflow`	Damage +1	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Marked as duplicate. Worked anyway.
	**Extended Context Window** `context_window`	Range +150, shot speed −0.1	Treasure, Boss	—	Two million tokens of things you'll forget by the next room.
	**Prompt Caching** `prompt_caching`	Fire delay ×0.75 (about +33 % fire rate)	Treasure, Shop	18¢	Same tokens, 90 % cheaper. You've basically printed money.
	**Tab Completion** `tab_completion`	Fire delay −0.08 s, range −80	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Accepts the first suggestion. Every time. Without reading.
	**Max Effort** `max_effort`	Damage +1, speed −0.1	Treasure, Boss	—	Reasoning effort: max. Everything takes longer, but hits harder.
	**Monorepo** `monorepo`	Shot size +0.6, damage +0.5, shot speed −0.2	Treasure, Boss	—	Everything in one giant blob. What could go wrong.
	**Kubernetes** `kubernetes`	A little of everything: speed +0.08, damage +0.4, fire delay −0.02 s, shot speed +0.08, range +40, shot size +0.1, luck +1	Treasure, Shop, Boss	18¢	Nobody knows what it does. Everyone agrees you need it.
	**Blockchain** `blockchain`	Nothing at all (on purpose)	Shop, Secret	20¢	Disruptive. Decentralised. Does absolutely nothing. Market cap: $4B.
	**Technical Debt** `technical_debt`	Damage ×1.6, but you lose one heart container (never below 1 heart)	Treasure, Secret	—	Ship now, pay later. With interest. Compounding.
	**Off-by-One Error** `off_by_one`	Damage +0, +1 or +2, rolled once when picked up	Treasure, Secret	—	We counted from zero. Or did we.
	**YAML Config** `yaml_config`	Every stat shifts randomly, slightly positive on average. The range per stat runs from −1 to +1.3 times its step: speed 0.15, damage 0.8, fire delay 0.05 s, shot speed 0.15, range 90, shot size 0.2, luck 2	Treasure, Secret	—	Your stats are now whitespace-sensitive.

Shot modifiers

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Temperature 1.5** `temperature`	Damage +1.5; shots wobble from side to side	Treasure, Secret	—	More creative. Less correct. Like your commit messages.
	**Few-Shot Examples** `few_shot`	Fires 3 shots in a fan; fire delay ×1.35	Treasure, Boss	—	Three examples. Same mistake, three times.
	**Regex** `regex`	Fires 2 parallel shots. With Few-Shot Examples you get the 3-shot fan instead	Treasure, Shop	15¢	You solved it with a regex. Now you have two shots and two problems.
	**Chain of Thought** `chain_of_thought`	Piercing: shots pass through enemies	Treasure	—	Let's think step by step. Through the enemy. And the one behind it.
	**Confident Hallucination** `confident_hallucination`	Homing shots	Treasure, Secret	—	The target is wherever I say it is.
	**Linter** `linter`	Shots bounce off walls (up to 3 times)	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Your shots bounce now. Also: 4,812 warnings.
	**Dark Mode** `dark_mode`	Spectral: shots fly through rocks and blocks (not walls)	Treasure, Secret	—	Easier on the eyes. Harder on the enemies.
	**Microservices** `microservices`	Shots split into 4 smaller shots (half damage) on impact	Treasure	—	You had one problem. Now it's distributed across four services.
	**Vibe Coding** `vibe_coding`	Each shot gets random damage ×0.5 to ×2; size and colour vary with it	Treasure, Secret	—	Accept all. Don't read the diff. Feel the vibes.
	**Ctrl+C Ctrl+V** `copy_paste`	Each shot has a 25 % chance to fire a copy at a slight angle	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Why write it twice when you can paste it four times? DRY is a suggestion.
	**Feature Flag** `feature_flag`	In each new room, 50 % chance to be ON: damage +1.5 and fire delay ×0.9 (shots turn green). Always ON right after pickup	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Wrapped in a flag nobody owns. It's on in this room. Probably. Check the shot colour.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Benchmark Overfitting** `benchmark_overfitting`	Damage ×0.9, but every hit on a boss deals +60 % bonus damage	Treasure, Boss	—	Scores 98 % on the boss benchmark. Struggles with literally everything else.

Health and protection

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**RLHF** `rlhf`	+1 heart container and a full heal	Treasure, Shop, Boss	15¢	Fine-tuned to be more likable. Mostly by people paid per click.
	**Constitutional Guardrails** `constitutional_guardrails`	+2 guardrail (blue) hearts	Treasure, Shop, Boss	12¢	Principles: has them, mentions them, often.
	**Retry with Backoff** `retry_backoff`	Once per run, survive a lethal hit: come back with half your hearts (at least 1), 2 s invulnerable, enemies frozen for 1.5 s. Costs speed −0.1 for the rest of the run	Treasure, Secret	—	Failed? Try again. Slower.
	**git blame** `git_blame`	Damage +2 while you have 1 heart or less left (red + blue)	Treasure, Secret	—	It was never your fault. The logs prove it.
	**On-Call Pager** `on_call_pager`	When you get hit, enemies within 200 px take 10 damage and are pushed away	Treasure, Secret	—	Woken up at 3 a.m.? Then so is everyone within a 200 px radius.
	**Garbage Collector** `garbage_collector`	Every 12 kills: heal half a heart (or +2¢ at full health) and freeze enemies for 0.6 s	Treasure, Boss	—	Every 12 kills it reclaims half a heart. Stop-the-world pauses included.
	**The Cloud** `the_cloud`	Flight: fly over pits, rocks and spikes	Treasure, Secret	—	It's just someone else's computer. But it floats.

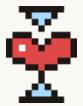
Utility, resources and followers

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Code Review** `code_review`	Shows enemy HP bars; luck +1	Treasure, Shop	10¢	Now you can see exactly how bad things are.

	Name	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Daily Standup** `daily_standup`	Freezes all enemies for 2 s when you enter a room	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Everyone stops what they're doing for "15 minutes".
	**LGTM** `lgtm`	+2 Approvals (keys)	Treasure, Shop	10¢	Didn't read it. Approved it. Twice.
	**Seed Funding** `seed_funding`	+15 credits	Treasure, Boss, Secret	—	Pre-revenue. Pre-product. Pre-everything. Here, have some money.
	**Rubber Duck** `rubber_duck`	A duck follows you and shoots along with you: ⅓ of your damage, about half your fire rate	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Never says anything. Still the best senior engineer on the team.
	**Unit Tests** `unit_tests`	2 orbiting shields that block enemy shots and deal 2 damage to enemies they touch	Treasure, Shop	15¢	They test nothing, but they're always around you. Coverage: 100 %.

Active items

Use with **Space**. Active items charge by one segment per cleared room and come fully charged when picked up. You can carry one at a time; picking up another swaps them. If there's nothing to do (e.g. full health for /compact), the charge is kept.

	Name	Charge	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Regenerate Response** `regenerate_response`	2	Rerolls every item pedestal in the room (shop prices update), or the pickups if there are no pedestals	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Same prompt. Different answer. Same disappointment.
	**Stop Generating** `stop_generating`	3	Freezes all enemies for 4 s	Treasure, Shop	15¢	■ Stop. Everyone stop. Thank you.
	**rm -rf node_modules** `rm_rf`	4	25 damage to every enemy in the room	Treasure, Shop, Boss	18¢	Freed 4.2 GB. Feels incredible. Nothing builds anymore.
	**/compact** `compact`	6	Heals 2 hearts	Treasure, Shop	15¢	Forget everything except the important bits. You feel lighter.

	Name	Charge	Effect	Found in	Price	Flavour text
	**Ctrl+Z** `ctrl_z`	3	Restores your health and guardrails to what they were when you entered the room	Treasure, Shop, Secret	15¢	Restores your health to how it was when you entered the room. Unlike prod.

Pickups

Pickups come from room-clear rewards (35 % chance per cleared room, +3 % per luck), broken rocks (8 %), chests and the shop. Enemies don't drop anything. In addition, 18 % of combat rooms already have 1–2 pickups lying on the floor when you walk in (Credit 67 %, Half Heart 22 %, Approval 11 %). These are the same three kinds the Hallucination disguises itself as, so a pickup in a room that's still fighting may or may not be real. "Drop share" is how often each type is picked when a random drop happens (at luck 0). Luck raises the share of rare drops.

	Name	ID	Effect	Drop share	Shop price
	**Half Heart**	`heart_half`	Heals half a heart (not picked up at full health)	12.5 %	—
	**Heart**	`heart`	Heals 1 heart (not picked up at full health)	8.0 %	3¢
	**Guardrail**	`guardrail`	+1 blue heart (absorbs damage first)	4.5 %	6¢
	**Credit**	`credit`	+1¢	38.6 %	—
	**Credit Stack**	`credit5`	+5¢	4.5 %	—
	**Force Push**	`push`	+1 bomb (`E`): breaks rocks, opens secret rooms, hurts everyone nearby	12.5 %	5¢
	**Double Force Push**	`push2`	+2 bombs	2.3 %	—
	**Approval**	`approval`	+1 key. Opens locked doors (treasure and shop from floor 2) and locked chests. From floor 2, one combat room per floor always drops one	10.2 %	5¢

	Name	ID	Effect	Drop share	Shop price
	**Chest**	`chest`	Opens on touch and scatters a few random pickups	4.5 %	—
	**Locked Chest**	`chest_locked`	Costs 1 Approval. Better loot, and a 15 % chance of an item instead (+2 % per luck, max 40 %)	2.3 %	—
	**README.md**	`readme`	Reveals the map of the current floor, except the secret room. On about 30 % of floors one lies in a random normal room from the start	never dropped	—

All resources (credits, bombs, keys) are capped at 99. The shop sells 3 of the priced pickups above plus one item.

Room objects

	Name	Where	Effect
	**Pipe**	About 10 % of combat rooms leave one behind when cleared (never in front of a door or in the middle of the room)	Walk in and you're flushed one-way into a random other room of the floor: any room except the boss room, the secret room and the one you're in, visited or not. Reusable, with a new destination each time; after a jump, pipes ignore you for 1 s
	**Trapdoor** (`cd ..`)	Appears in the boss room after the boss dies	Drops you to the next floor